

Disclaimer: About Flash Fill features covered in the next "More Excel Features for Cleaning Data" video

The following video covers the use of Flash Fill and Text to Columns features in Excel for cleaning data. Please note that there has been a recent update regarding the Flash Fill feature, and corrections are currently in progress. As a result, some details in the video may not accurately reflect the latest functionality.

Note: Both the Flash Fill and Text to Columns features can be used to split a single column containing two names into two separate columns, each with one name.

Use Case for Flash Fill:

If you have full names in the "Customer Contact" column and want to split the first name and last name into two separate columns.

Using Flash Fill in Excel for the Web:

To do this, first type the last name of the first record. Then, under the "Data" tab, click on the "Flash Fill" option.

Customer_Contacts_2.2.2.3_Start-Copy

Search for tools, help, and more (Alt + Q)

File Home Insert Share Page Layout Formulas **Data** Review View Automate Help Draw

Data from Picture Get & Transform Data Data from Power BI Refresh All Refresh All Queries & Connections Workbook Links Stocks Currencies Geograp... Data Types Sort Ascending Sort Descending Custom Sort Filter Clear Reapply Split Text to Columns **Flash Fill** Remove Duplicates Data Validation Data Tools

B2 Saveley

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Customer Contact	Last Name	First Name										
2	Saveley, Mary	Saveley											
3	Tannamuri, Yoshi												
4	Tonini, Daniel												
5	Nelson, Valarie												
6	Murphy, Leslie												
7	Shimamura, Akiko												
8	Huxley, Adrian												
9	Frick, Michael												
10	Ferguson, Peter												

This will automatically fill the remaining cells with the last names extracted from the original column. You can do the same for the first names as well.

Customer_Contacts_2.2.2.3_Start-Copy

Search for tools, help, and more (Alt + Q)

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Data from Picture Get & Transform Data Data from Power BI Queries & Connections Refresh All Workbook Links

Stocks Currencies Geograp... Data Types

Sort Ascending Sort Descending Custom Sort Filter Clear Reapply Split Text to Columns Flash Fill

B2 Saveley

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Customer Contact	Last Name	First Name									
2	Saveley, Mary	Saveley										
3	Tannamuri, Yoshi	Tannamuri										
4	Tonini, Daniel	Tonini										
5	Nelson, Valarie	Nelson										
6	Murphy, Leslie	Murphy										
7	Shimamura, Akiko	Shimamura										
8	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley										
9	Frick, Michael	Frick										
10	Ferguson, Peter	Ferguson										
11	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley										
12	Taylor, Sue	Taylor										
13	Freyre, Diego	Freyre										
14	Thompson, Steve	Thompson										
15	Saveley, Mary	Saveley										

Using Flash Fill in the Desktop Version:

First, type the last name of the first record. Then, start typing the last name of the second record. At this point, Excel will show previews of the remaining last names.

Excel interface showing the Flash Fill feature. The ribbon includes File, Home, Insert, Page Layout, Formulas, Data, Review, View, Automate, and Help. The Home ribbon is active, showing options for Clipboard, Font, Alignment, and Number. The formula bar shows the active cell B3 containing the text "Tannamuri".

The spreadsheet data is as follows:

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Customer Contact	Last Name	First Name					
2	Saveley, Mary	Saveley						
3	Tannamuri, Yoshi	Tannamuri						
4	Tonini, Daniel	Tonini						
5	Nelson, Valarie	Nelson						
6	Murphy, Leslie	Murphy						
7	Shimamura, Akiko	Shimamura						
8	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley						
9	Frick, Michael	Frick						
10	Ferguson, Peter	Ferguson						
11	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley						
12	Taylor, Sue	Taylor						
13	Freyre, Diego	Freyre						
14	Thompson, Steve	Thompson						
15	Saveley, Mary	Saveley						
16	Freyre, Diego	Freyre						
17	Petersen, Jytte	Petersen						
18	Accorti, Paolo	Accorti						

Press Enter to automatically fill in all the other last names. You can do the same for the first names as well.

Excel interface showing the Flash Fill feature. The ribbon is set to **Home**. The **Clipboard** group shows **Paste**. The **Font** group shows **Aptos Narrow** font, size **11**, and **B**, *I*, U options. The **Alignment** group shows **Center**, **Left**, **Right**, and **Justify** options. The **Formulas** group shows **fx**. The **Review** group shows **Spelling & Grammar**. The **View** group shows **Gridlines**, **Headings**, and **Formulas**.

The active cell is **B3**, containing the text **Tannamuri**. The formula bar shows **Tannamuri**.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Customer Contact	Last Name	First Name			
2	Saveley, Mary	Saveley				
3	Tannamuri, Yoshi	Tannamuri				
4	Tonini, Daniel	Tonini				
5	Nelson, Valarie	Nelson				
6	Murphy, Leslie	Murphy				
7	Shimamura, Akiko	Shimamura				
8	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley				
9	Frick, Michael	Frick				
10	Ferguson, Peter	Ferguson				
11	Huxley, Adrian	Huxley				
12	Taylor, Sue	Taylor				
13	Freyre, Diego	Freyre				
14	Thompson, Steve	Thompson				
15	Saveley, Mary	Saveley				
16	Freyre, Diego	Freyre				
17	Petersen, Jytte	Petersen				
18	Accorti, Paolo	Accorti				
19	Ashworth, Victoria	Ashworth				
20	King, Sue	King				
21	Frick, Michael	Frick				

✓ **Completed**